

UTTARAKHAND

The Westin Resort & Spa Himalayas, Garhwal

With an ultra-modern façade rising in stark contrast to the mountainous terrain, the Westin Himalayas is one of the newest luxury destinations in the hills with a view unlike any. Perched at 4,500 feet in the foothills of the Garhwal Himalayas, the 141-key resort offers an unparalleled view of the Shivalik mountains flanked by Dehradun on one side and Rishikesh on the other, with the holy Ganga meandering through the landscape. You could venture out to explore these popular tourist hotspots, or you could stay put and soak in the vistas from the infinity pool, partake in an engaging teppanyaki experience at the speciality Asian restaurant Toya, or indulge in holistic treatments at the tranquil in-house spa.

From Rs 29,500
www.marriott.com

The Kumaon, Almora

Blessed with native forests, hidden waterfalls and terraced farms, Uttarakhand's Kumaon region offers some of the most astounding mountain views, with rustic villages and medieval stone temples dotting the landscape. Nestled in these verdant environs, in the shadow of the sacred Nanda Devi range, The Kumaon is an escape in the truest sense. Ten luxurious suites are built with sustainable, locally sourced materials, and fitted with traditional wood-burning bukharis and floor-to-ceiling windows overlooking the mountains and valleys. A cantilevered dining space suspended over the valley serves a mix of Kumaoni and world cuisines, with focus on seasonal local produce and foraged ingredients.

From Rs 28,000
www.thekumaon.com



HIMACHAL PRADESH

Amaya, Solan

Barely two hours away from the din and chaos of city life is a sanctuary nestled amidst a misty pine forest on a rolling hillside, with spectacular views of the Himalayas. Born of a philosophy to enrich the lives of all inhabitants along with the land upon which it's built, Amaya offers a choice of chalets, suites and villas designed by Bijoy Jain of Studio Mumbai and built entirely by hand, without the use of any cement. The Nordic minimalism is complemented by stone-paved walkways, terraced fields and mountain trails, and accentuated with a fine-dining restaurant, a heated pool and sauna, and a cultural immersion in the nearby village of Darwa.

From Rs 27,500
www.theamayalife.com

Sitara Himalaya, Leh-Manali Highway

Guided by the ancient wisdom that everything in the universe is connected, Sitara Himalaya offers a private sanctuary to pause and connect with nature. Located on a sacred hill, the 10-room resort is tucked between the mighty Dhauladhar and Pir Panjal ranges at an altitude of 8,200 feet. An extension of Good Earth founder Anita Lal's holiday home, it sports a local architectural style while being luxuriously appointed with the lifestyle brand's elegant aesthetics. A yogshala, hot water plunge pool, infra-red sauna and steam room all infused with Himalayan elements such as rock crystals or salt bricks, add a restorative wellness aspect to a stay here.

Tariff on request
www.sitarahimalaya.com